MERCY'S ANATOMY

Season 2, Episode 17 (Part Two of Two)

"Hold On"

Episode 2x17. The counterpart of *Grey's Anatomy* 2x17 (Part Two of the Code Black two-parter).
Narrator: Dr. Marc-Anthony Bullock

In-story dates: Sunday, February 5, 2006 (Super Bowl XL), 6:22 PM through 11:59 PM

Script: Cold Open + 5 Acts + Tag. 48 scenes. Standard: MA-009

Depends on MA-001 through MA-011 and episodes 1x01-2x16. Continues directly from 2x16.

EPISODE PDF PACKAGE (MA-009 §6): 1. Title page and cast (with ages on Sunday, February 5, 2006). 2. Script. 3. Media Companion. 4. Continuity Sheet.

Cast in Order of Appearance (Ages on Sunday, February 5, 2006)

Character	Role in this episode	Born	Age
Dr. Marc-Anthony Bullock	Surgical Intern (narrator)	Jan 5, 1979	27
Det. Sgt. Isaac Burrell	NYPD Bomb Squad (killed in the line of duty, 6:31 PM)	Sep 14, 1961	44
Dr. Abraham Lowery	Attending General Surgeon	Jan 9, 1947	59
Dr. Edwin Mabry	Chief of Anesthesiology	Jun 24, 1957	48
Dr. Elxa Bullock	Surgical Resident (delivered 6:44 PM)	Aug 29, 1977	28
Dr. Harmony Divine	Surgical Intern (delivered Tuck)	Jun 19, 1979	26
Dr. Hampton (V.O., then on-screen)	Elxa's obstetrician	Apr 20, 1950	55
Dr. Natasha Donohue	Chief of Surgery	Jun 2, 1958	47
Dr. Robert Bullock	Chief of Cardiothoracic Surgery	Feb 10, 1956	49
Darius 'Dash' Duvall	Patient: Status 1A, day 86	Aug 8, 1971	34
Glenda Duvall	Dash's mother	Dec 12, 1947	58
Dr. Raven Ellison	Surgical Intern	Dec 3, 1979	26
Dr. Esther Smilley	Surgical Intern	Sep 20, 1979	26
Dr. Leland Graves	Chief of Neurosurgery	Apr 18, 1953	52
Raymond 'Big Ray' Toles	Chief of Security	Jan 1, 1960	46
Dr. Victor Donohue	Marc's grandfather	May 30, 1933	72
Lillian Divine	Harmony's mother	Feb 14, 1952	53
Howard Divine	Harmony's father	Aug 30, 1950	55
Dr. Camille Toussaint	Orthopedic Resident	Jul 21, 1976	29
LaShawn Plummer	Reggie's wife	Aug 3, 1969	36
Lamont 'Monty' Gaines	Owner, Monty's on Jackson	Oct 10, 1962	43
Cedric Hall	Architect; Monty's partner	Jan 22, 1965	41
Nurse Kendra Wallace	Surgical Floor Nurse	May 30, 1980	25
Nurse Gloria Pettiford	Head ER Nurse	Apr 14, 1952	53
Captain Neville Ashford (new)	Commanding Officer, NYPD Bomb Squad	Dec 8, 1949	56
Danita Crews	FDNY paramedic	Jun 26, 1978	27
Dr. Bryce Kennerly	Surgical Intern	Jun 11, 1978	27
Hattie 'Miss Hattie' Lomax	Cafeteria	Mar 3, 1945	60
Dr. Clayton Hartwell	OB/GYN and Fetal Surgeon	Mar 3, 1971	34
Dr. Amond Baker	Surgical Intern	Feb 10, 1979	26

Character	Role in this episode	Born	Age
Dr. Arianna Cummings	Surgical Intern	Oct 25, 1979	26
Dr. Horace Whitlow	Chief of Medicine	Sep 19, 1949	56
Russell Jeffries	Elxa's husband (post-craniectomy)	Apr 3, 1975	30
Angela Burrell (new)	Isaac's widow	Jul 22, 1963	42
Imani Burrell (new)	Isaac's daughter (turns 8 on February 7)	Feb 7, 1998	7
Reginald 'Reggie' Plummer	Patient: shell removed	Oct 30, 1967	38
Dr. Grace Bullock (V.O.)	Harvard Medical School student	Apr 12, 1981	24
Russell Harmon 'Tuck' Jeffries Jr. (born)	Elxa and Russell's son	Feb 5, 2006	0
Mercy	The House's pit bull puppy	Sep 30, 2005	0

Also appearing: NYPD Bomb Squad officers and uniformed police (the honor lines), a NICU transport team, hospital staff along the loading-dock path, an old Monty's regular, a TV reporter, and Reggie and LaShawn's toddler son. On TV: Super Bowl XL (Willie Parker's 75-yard touchdown run; Steelers 21, Seahawks 10).

COLD OPEN

1 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - OR 1 - NIGHT
SUNDAY, FEBRUARY 5, 2006 - 6:22 PM

Silence, except for the soft rhythmic squeeze of Mabry's hand on the ventilation bag. Marc (27) kneels on the step stool. Burrell (44), in his full bomb suit, crouches beside him with the open containment pot. Lowery (59) holds the wound edges open with his gloved hands.

BURRELL
(through the helmet)
One.

Marc lifts. Slowly. His hand rises out of Reggie's body, his fingers wrapped around the rusted olive-drab shell. An inch. Two. It comes free of the wound, dark with blood and old mud. He holds it straight, perfectly level, in the air above the open abdomen.

MARC (V.O.)
They teach you in medical school that the body has its own wisdom.

Burrell raises both gloved hands under Marc's. Marc lowers the shell into Burrell's palms. For a second, both of them hold it. Then Marc lets go.

BURRELL
(very quietly)
I have it, Doctor. (beat) Let go.

Burrell lowers the shell into the containment pot. He closes the lid with a heavy click and turns two latches.

MARC (V.O.)
That before the mind knows, the body already does.

2 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - OR 1 - NIGHT
SUNDAY, FEBRUARY 5, 2006 - 6:24 PM

Burrell stands with the heavy pot against his chest. He looks at Marc through the face shield. Marc's hand is

still in the air, empty, shaking now for the first time in four hours.

BURRELL
(beat)
You did good, Dr. Bullock. (beat)
Go wash your hands.

MARC
(beat, barely)
Sergeant.

BURRELL
(beat)
Find yourself a Tuesday, son.

He turns and walks to the east door of the operating room, the one that leads to the service corridor. A police officer holds it open for him. He walks through. The door swings shut.

MARC (V.O.)
A racing heart. A hand that won't stop shaking.

Lowery looks down at the empty space in Reggie's abdomen where the shell was.

LOWERY
(beat, very quietly)
Edwin. (beat) Let's close this man up.

MABRY
(beat, still bagging)
Gladly, Abraham.

MARC (V.O.)
The body trying to tell you something you're not ready to hear.

END OF COLD OPEN

ACT ONE

3 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - STAIRWELL C - NIGHT
SUNDAY, FEBRUARY 5, 2006 - 6:28 PM

The emergency lights. Elxa (28) on the landing against the wall, on Harmony's white coat, red-faced, pushing with a deep, raw groan. Harmony (26) kneels in front of her, gloved, steady. The cell phone lies on the step, on speaker.

DR. HAMPTON (V.O.)
(on the phone)
...when you see the head, Harmony, you don't pull. (beat) You guide. (beat) Let her do the work.

HARMONY
(calm)
I see the head. (beat) Dr. Bullock, I see the head. (beat) He has hair. (beat) So much hair.

ELXA
(collapsing back between pushes, gasping)
Of course he does. (beat) He's a Donohue.

A sound from far away, down through the building: the distant roar of a crowd from a TV somewhere. The kickoff.

ELXA
(beat, half laughing, half crying)
Oh, God. (beat) The Super Bowl. (beat) Russell's going to miss the kickoff.

HARMONY
(beat, gently)
Russell's going to miss a lot of things tonight. (beat) Not this one. (beat) You'll tell him.

DR. HAMPTON (V.O.)
(on the phone)
Next contraction, Elxa. (beat) Chin to your chest.

4 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - SERVICE CORRIDOR - OLD WING - NIGHT
SUNDAY, FEBRUARY 5, 2006 - 6:29 PM

A long, narrow concrete corridor with pipes along the ceiling and old fluorescent fixtures, empty, leading to the loading dock doors at the far end. Burrell walks down the middle of it alone, slowly, the containment pot held against his chest in both arms. His breath fogs the inside of his face shield. Two officers stand at the far end by the loading dock, holding the doors.

One of the fluorescent tubes overhead flickers. Buzzes. Flickers. Burrell glances up at it and keeps walking.

BURRELL
(to himself, softly)
Tuesday. (beat) Pink. (beat) Tuesday.

Forty feet to go. Thirty-five.

5 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - OR 1 - SCRUB ROOM - NIGHT
SUNDAY, FEBRUARY 5, 2006 - 6:30 PM

Marc stands at the long steel scrub sink, staring at his hands under the running water. Blood and rust swirl down the drain. His hands are shaking badly now. He can't make them stop. Through the small window in the door, he can see down the service corridor: the white bulk of Burrell's suit, walking away toward the loading dock.

Outside the other door, Natasha (47) and Robert (49) wait behind the police line. Natasha sees Marc through the

glass and presses her hand flat to it again. Marc looks up and sees her.

MARC
(barely, through the glass, though she can't hear)
Mama.

He looks back through the window down the corridor. Burrell is twenty feet from the loading dock. The flickering fluorescent tube above him buzzes loudly and goes dark.

6 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - SERVICE CORRIDOR - OLD WING - NIGHT
SUNDAY, FEBRUARY 5, 2006 - 6:31 PM

A blinding white flash. A sound like the end of the world.

END OF ACT ONE

ACT TWO

7 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - OR 1 - SCRUB ROOM - NIGHT
SUNDAY, FEBRUARY 5, 2006 - 6:31 PM

Silence. High-pitched ringing. Dust and smoke. The small window in the scrub-room door has cracked into a spiderweb. Marc lies on the floor under the steel sink, where the blast threw him. The water is still running. Blood trickles from a cut above his left eyebrow.

He can't hear anything. He sees, as if underwater: ceiling tiles drifting down; a fire alarm strobe flashing; the door to the corridor bursting open; his father running through it, his mouth open, shouting something Marc can't hear.

Robert drops to his knees beside his son and takes his face in both hands.

ROBERT
(shouting, muffled, far away)
Marc! (beat) Marc! (beat) Look at me!

Marc looks at him. Robert's hands move over his skull, his neck, his chest, his arms, a surgeon's hands checking for injuries. Natasha is right behind him. She kneels on the other side, in her good coat, in the dust.

MARC
(dazed, too loud, unable to hear his own voice)
I can't hear you.

NATASHA
(exaggerating every word so he can read her lips)
You're alive.

Marc stares at her. Then he looks past her, through the shattered window, down the corridor full of smoke.

MARC
(beat)
Where's the sergeant?

8 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - STAIRWELL C - NIGHT
SUNDAY, FEBRUARY 5, 2006 - 6:32 PM

The stairwell shudders. Dust sifts down from the ceiling. The emergency lights flicker and come back. Harmony throws herself forward over Elxa instinctively, covering her and the baby that isn't born yet. The phone on the step crackles.

DR. HAMPTON (V.O.)
(on the phone, frantic)
Harmony! (beat) Harmony, what was that? (beat) We heard it out here! (beat) The whole street heard it!

Harmony slowly lifts her head. Elxa stares up at the ceiling, wide-eyed, her breath coming in gasps.

ELXA
(beat, barely)
That was the bomb.

HARMONY
(beat, very quietly)
I know.

ELXA
(beat)
My brother's down there. (beat) Marc is down there.

Harmony looks at Elxa. She knows. Everyone in the building who heard the overhead page and saw the police in the old wing knows. She says nothing about it. She puts both hands back in position.

HARMONY
(beat, steady)
Dr. Bullock. (beat) Look at me. (beat) Not at the ceiling. (beat) At me. (beat) Your son is coming. (beat) Right now. (beat) Next contraction. (beat) Push.

9 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - SERVICE CORRIDOR - OLD WING - NIGHT
SUNDAY, FEBRUARY 5, 2006 - 6:35 PM

Smoke. Twisted pipe. The overhead lights are gone; flashlight beams cut through the haze. The loading dock doors at the far end hang off their hinges. Three bomb squad officers move through the debris toward something on the floor near the end of the corridor. Marc stumbles into the corridor behind them, his father trying to hold him back by the arm.

ROBERT
(shouting)
Marc, no!

Marc pulls free. An officer turns and catches him by the shoulders. Over the officer's shoulder, in the flashlight beams, Marc sees the white bulk of the bomb suit lying still on the concrete, and the two officers kneeling beside it. One of them takes off his own helmet and bows his head.

Marc stops struggling. The officer holding him looks into his face.

OFFICER
(gently, his mouth moving clearly)
He's gone, Doc. (beat) The pot didn't hold. (beat) He's gone.

Marc's knees buckle. The officer holds him up. Robert reaches him and takes his son's weight from the officer. Marc stands in his father's arms in the smoke and stares at the man on the floor who told him to find a Tuesday.

MARC
(barely, unable to hear himself)
He said "Tuesday."

10 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - STAIRWELL C - NIGHT
SUNDAY, FEBRUARY 5, 2006 - 6:44 PM

Elxa bears down with a scream that echoes up four flights of concrete. Harmony kneels, her hands cradling the emerging head. The face turns. A thick, bluish loop of umbilical cord is wrapped around the baby's neck.

HARMONY
(beat, very calm, to the phone)
Dr. Hampton, the cord's around his neck.

DR. HAMPTON (V.O.)
(instantly, steady)
Is it loose enough to slip over his head?

HARMONY
(feeling it with one finger)
I think so.

DR. HAMPTON (V.O.)
Then slip it over his head, honey. (beat) Gently. (beat) Now.

Harmony hooks one gloved finger under the cord and slides it over the baby's head. It comes free.

HARMONY
(beat)
It's off.

DR. HAMPTON (V.O.)
(beat)
Then let her push.

HARMONY
(beat, to Elxa)
Push, Elxa. (beat) Push.

Elxa pushes. One shoulder, then the other. And then, all at once, slippery and gray and furious, the baby slides into Harmony's hands. Silence. One second. Two. Harmony turns him over, rubs his back hard with her palm.

He takes a breath. Then he screams. A huge, outraged, wonderful scream that fills the stairwell and goes up four flights and down three.

HARMONY
(sobbing and
laughing at once)
He's here. (beat) He's here,
Elxa. (beat) He's a boy. (beat)
He's a big, loud boy.

DR. HAMPTON (V.O.)
(on the phone,
crying)
Time, Harmony. (beat) What time
is it?

Harmony glances at her watch through her tears.

HARMONY
(beat)
Six forty-four p.m.

END OF ACT TWO

ACT THREE

11 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - STAIRWELL C - NIGHT
SUNDAY, FEBRUARY 5, 2006 - 6:47 PM

The baby lies on Elxa's bare chest, slippery and pink now, crying in outraged bursts. Harmony has tied the cord with two shoelaces from her own sneakers and cut it with the bandage scissors from her pocket. She pulls off her scrub top, leaving her in a T-shirt, and drapes it over both of them. Then she takes her white coat from under Elxa and wraps the baby in it, folding the long sleeves around him, tucking the edges in tight like a swaddle.

HARMONY
(softly, tucking the last corner)
There. (beat) Tucked in. (beat) Like a burrito.

Elxa looks down at the furious little face peering out of a white coat that says "H. DIVINE, M.D." over the pocket.

ELXA
(whispering, crying)
Look at you. (beat) Tucked in a surgeon's coat. (beat) Tuck. (beat) Hi, Tuck.

HARMONY
(beat, laughing through tears)
Tuck?

ELXA
(beat)
His name is Russell. (beat) Like his daddy. (beat) Russell Jeffries, Junior. (beat) But we're going to call him Tuck.

The baby stops crying. He opens his eyes and looks up at his mother with the unfocused, serious stare of the very new.

ELXA
(beat, to Harmony, not taking her eyes off the baby)
And his middle name is Harmon.

Harmony stops breathing.

HARMONY
(barely)
What?

ELXA
(beat)
Russell Harmon Jeffries Junior. (beat) After the woman who caught him in a stairwell during a bomb on Super Bowl Sunday with a pair of shoelaces. (beat) Don't argue with me, Divine. (beat) I've had a long day.

Harmony sits back on her heels on the concrete step and sobs. From the phone on the step, Dr. Hampton's voice, thick with tears.

DR. HAMPTON (V.O.)
(on the phone)
Twenty-eight years. (beat) That's the first one I ever delivered by phone. (beat) And I didn't do a thing.

12 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - CVICU - BED 5 - NIGHT
SUNDAY, FEBRUARY 5, 2006 - 6:49 PM

The CVICU lights have flickered back. The TV shows the Super Bowl, first quarter, the sound off. Dash sits up rigid in the bed, his monitor alarming: heart rate one forty. Glenda holds his shoulders. Raven stands frozen in the middle of the room with her cell phone at her ear. Every phone in the building has been turned back on.

RAVEN
(into the phone, barely)
Amond. (beat) Amond, the building shook. (beat) Is he... (beat) Is Marc...

She listens. Her whole body sags. She grabs the bed rail.

RAVEN
(beat, a sob)
He's alive. (beat) He's alive. (beat) A cut. (beat) His hearing. (beat) He's alive.

Dash lets out a long breath. On the monitor, his heart rate begins to fall: one thirty, one twenty, one ten. Glenda closes her eyes.

RAVEN
(beat, into the phone)
And the sergeant? (beat) The bomb squad...

She listens. She closes her eyes.

RAVEN
(barely)
Oh, no.

DASH
(quietly)
Go, Raven. (beat) Go to your friend.

RAVEN
(beat)
I promised you the game.

DASH
(beat)
You promised me "when he walks out." (beat) He hasn't walked out yet. (beat) Go make him walk out. (beat) Then come back for the third quarter.

13 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - NEURO ICU - BED 2 - NIGHT

SUNDAY, FEBRUARY 5, 2006 - 6:51 PM

The Neuro ICU, two floors and a whole wing from the blast. A cracked ceiling tile hangs by one corner over the nurses' station. Esther stands at Russell's bedside where she threw herself across his bandaged head twenty minutes ago, when the floor jumped. She's still shaking. Graves comes in fast, out of breath.

GRAVES
(beat)
Pressure?

ESTHER
(beat, reading the monitor)
ICP spiked to twenty-eight when the building shook. (beat) He bucked the vent. (beat) I pushed propofol and he came back down. (beat) Fourteen now. (beat) Twelve.

GRAVES
(beat, checking the bolt himself)
Good. (beat) Good catch, Dr. Smilley.

Esther looks at the cracked ceiling tile, then out the window toward the old wing, where smoke still curls under the floodlights.

ESTHER
(barely)
Dr. Graves. (beat) Marc Bullock was in OR One.

GRAVES
(beat, quietly)
I know. (beat) Big Ray called the charge nurse five minutes ago. (beat) Bullock's alive. (beat) A cut and his ears. (beat) The sergeant isn't.

Esther grips the bed rail. She closes her eyes. She doesn't let go of Russell's hand.

GRAVES
(beat, gently)
Stay with this one, Dr. Smilley. (beat) The other one has his family. (beat) This one only has you until his wife can get here.

14 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - OR 1 - NIGHT
SUNDAY, FEBRUARY 5, 2006 - 6:53 PM

Smoke still hangs in the air near the east door, and dust coats every surface. A ceiling tile has fallen onto the back table. But Reggie's abdomen is closed. Lowery ties the last skin suture. Mabry, still bagging by hand, glances at the monitor. Steady. Then Lowery lifts his hands from the field and holds them out in front of him. They're shaking. Violently.

MABRY
(beat, dry, gentle)
Now you shake?

LOWERY
(beat, staring at his hands)
Now I can, Edwin. (beat) Now I'm allowed.

He lowers his hands slowly to his sides. He looks at the east door, at the dust, at the smoke curling under it.

LOWERY
(beat, very quietly)
He walked right past me. (beat) That sergeant. (beat) Carrying it. (beat) He said, "Thank you, Doctor." (beat) I didn't say anything back. (beat) I was looking at the wound.

MABRY
(beat)
That was your job, Abraham.

LOWERY
(beat)
I know. (beat) I'd still like to have said something.

15 EXT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - JACKSON AVENUE - POLICE PERIMETER - NIGHT
SUNDAY, FEBRUARY 5, 2006 - 6:56 PM

Chaos at the tape. People are crying and pushing at the barricades. Police shout. Smoke curls from the loading dock area at the side of the old wing. Ambulances pull up with their lights on. Victor stands perfectly still at the barricade, gripping it with both hands. Lillian holds Camille against her. LaShawn holds her toddler and sobs. Big Ray, just inside the tape, has a radio pressed to his ear.

BIG RAY
(into the radio)
Say again. (beat) Say again, all of it.

He listens. He lowers the radio. He turns to the crowd at the tape, finds Victor, and speaks directly to him.

BIG RAY
(beat)
The doctors are alive, Dr. Donohue. (beat) All of them. (beat) The patient's alive. (beat) Marc's alive. (beat) He's cut. He can't hear right. (beat) But he's alive.

Victor's grip on the barricade loosens. His knees bend. Cedric catches him under one arm, Monty under the other, and they lower the seventy-two-year-old man gently to sit on the curb in his overcoat. Victor puts his face in his hands.

LASHAWN
(to Big Ray, frantic)
My husband?

BIG RAY
(beat)
Alive, Mrs. Plummer. (beat) They closed him up. (beat) He's alive.

LaShawn sinks to her knees on the wet sidewalk with her son. Big Ray looks back at the radio in his hand. His face changes.

BIG RAY
(beat, quietly, to nobody)
The sergeant didn't make it.

16 INT. MONTY'S ON JACKSON - BAR - NIGHT
SUNDAY, FEBRUARY 5, 2006 - 7:02 PM

The bar is nearly empty; everyone is across the street at the tape. Only Kendra Wallace, a few nurses and an old regular remain, all standing at the window. On the TV, the Super Bowl plays on: first quarter, Seattle driving. Nobody watches. Behind the bar, a framed photo of the Grace's 1998 softball team has fallen off the wall and shattered from the blast.

Kendra picks up the broken frame. In the photo, a younger Gloria Pettiford in a softball jersey grins beside a younger Monty.

KENDRA
(beat, to the old regular)
It shook the glasses. (beat) From across the street.

OLD REGULAR
(beat, quietly)
I was in Brooklyn in '93 when the Trade Center got hit the first time. (beat) That's what this felt like. (beat) Like the ground had a heart attack.

17 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - EMERGENCY DEPARTMENT - TRAUMA 3 - NIGHT
SUNDAY, FEBRUARY 5, 2006 - 7:08 PM

Marc sits on the edge of a gurney, still in his bloody scrubs, dust in his hair. Gloria cleans the cut above his eyebrow with saline and closes it with Steri-Strips. Natasha stands on one side of him, Robert on the other. Marc's hearing is coming back in pieces: muffled voices, a hiss, a high whine.

GLORIA
(holding up an otoscope, speaking slowly and loudly)
Your eardrums are intact, baby. (beat) Both of them. (beat) Temporary threshold shift. (beat) It'll come back in a day or two. (beat) The ringing might take a week.

MARC
(too loudly)
I can hear you. (beat) Sort of. (beat) Like you're underwater.

NATASHA
(taking his hand)
That's enough for tonight.

A tall, gray-haired NYPD officer in uniform with captain's bars comes into the bay with his hat under his arm: CAPTAIN NEVILLE ASHFORD (56), commander of the Bomb Squad.

ASHFORD
(beat, formally)
Dr. Bullock. (beat) I'm Captain Ashford. (beat) Isaac Burrell was my sergeant for eleven years. (beat) I'm told you held that device for four hours. (beat) And handed it to him.

MARC
(beat)
Yes, sir.

ASHFORD
(beat)
He radioed from the corridor, before. (beat) The last thing he said on the radio was, "The doctor's clear. Starting my walk." (beat) You were his last report, son. (beat) He was proud of how you held it.

Marc looks down at his hands. They've stopped shaking. He doesn't know whether that's better or worse.

MARC
(beat)
Captain. (beat) When you take him out of the building... (beat) I want to be there.

18 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - STAIRWELL D - OLD WING - NIGHT
SUNDAY, FEBRUARY 5, 2006 - 7:14 PM

Danita sits where Kennerly and Arianna left her, on the landing, her knees pulled up, hugging her cramped hand.

Kennerly comes back down the stairs with two cups of water. He sits on the step below her and hands her one. She doesn't take it.

DANITA
(beat, barely)
The building shook.

KENNERLY
(beat)
I know.

DANITA
(beat)
Did it go off? (beat) Inside?
(beat) With the doctor?

KENNERLY
(beat)
In the corridor. (beat) After.
(beat) The doctor's alive. (beat)
The patient's alive.

A long beat. Danita looks at him.

DANITA
(beat, whispering)
Who?

Kennerly sets her cup of water down on the step between them.

KENNERLY
(beat, honestly)
The bomb squad sergeant. (beat)
Burrell. (beat) He was carrying
it out. (beat) He's dead.

Danita covers her mouth. She folds over her knees and makes a sound Kennerly has never heard a person make. He doesn't say anything. He doesn't leave. He sits on the step below her, the way Gloria sat with him, and waits.

19 EXT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - LOADING DOCK - NIGHT
SUNDAY, FEBRUARY 5, 2006 - 7:24 PM

Floodlights. The loading dock is scorched and the doors are gone. An NYPD ambulance waits in the alley with its back doors open. Along both sides of the path from the dock to the ambulance, two long lines of bomb squad officers and uniformed police stand at attention in the cold. Behind them, more and more hospital staff in scrubs and white coats join the lines: nurses, security guards, cafeteria workers, residents. Miss Hattie. Big Ray. Mabry. Lowery, his hands now still.

At the end of one line, in bloody scrubs, a white bandage over his eyebrow, Marc stands between his father and his mother.

Six officers carry a stretcher out of the loading dock. On it, a body covered with an American flag and, on top of the flag, a single NYPD Bomb Squad patch. They walk slowly between the lines. Every officer salutes. Every hospital worker stands still. Some put their hands over their hearts.

As the stretcher passes Marc, he raises his right hand, the hand that held the shell, and lays it flat over his own heart.

MARC (V.O.)
They teach you in medical school
that the body has its own wisdom.

The officers lift the stretcher into the ambulance and close the doors. The ambulance pulls away slowly, its lights on and no siren, down the alley toward Jackson Avenue. Nobody moves until it's gone.

20 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - STAIRWELL C - NIGHT
SUNDAY, FEBRUARY 5, 2006 - 7:33 PM

The lockdown has been lifted. With a mechanical clunk, the fire door at the bottom of the flight unlocks. It bursts open. Clayton runs through it with a NICU nurse and a transport team. Behind them, taking the stairs two at a time in a soaked raincoat, comes Dr. Hampton.

They stop on the landing. Elxa is propped against the wall with her son on her chest, wrapped in Harmony's white coat. Harmony sits beside her in a bloody T-shirt with no

shoelaces in her sneakers.

CLAYTON
(beat, breathless, staring)
You did it.

HARMONY
(beat, hoarse)
She did it. (beat) I caught.

Dr. Hampton kneels on the step, checks the baby with a practiced hand, then Elxa. She sits back and looks at Harmony.

DR. HAMPTON
(beat)
Shoelaces?

HARMONY
(beat)
They were the only thing I had that would tie.

DR. HAMPTON
(beat, laughing and crying at once)
Lord, child. (beat) Shoelaces.

Footsteps on the stairs above. Natasha comes down the last flight in her ruined coat, dust on her sleeves, her face streaked. She stops on the landing above them. She looks down at her daughter and the baby in the white coat.

ELXA
(beat, looking up, exhausted, radiant)
Mama. (beat) Meet Tuck.

Natasha sits down on the step above her daughter. She reaches over Elxa's shoulder and touches the baby's cheek with one finger. Then she puts her face in her hands and weeps, for the first time all day.

END OF ACT THREE

ACT FOUR

21 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - EMERGENCY DEPARTMENT - CORRIDOR - NIGHT
SUNDAY, FEBRUARY 5, 2006 - 7:46 PM

Marc walks slowly back in from the loading dock, Robert's hand on his shoulder. At the end of the corridor, running: Raven, Amond, Arianna and Esther. They reach him. Raven throws her arms around him first, sobbing. Arianna puts her hand flat on his back. Esther stands one step away, her face white, holding herself very still.

Amond is the last. He stops in front of Marc. He looks at the bandage, the bloody scrubs, the dust.

AMOND
(beat, quietly)
You stayed in a room you couldn't leave.

MARC
(beat, too loud, still half deaf)
What?

Amond takes Marc's face in both hands, the way Robert did in the scrub room, and speaks slowly enough for him to read his lips.

AMOND
(beat)
You call me your day one. (beat) I never told you what you are to me. (beat) You're not my day one, Marc. (beat) You're my brother.

Marc stares at him. Then he puts his forehead against Amond's. Amond, who doesn't hug people, wraps his arms around him and holds on.

AMOND
(beat, barely)
My father bled out before anybody got there. (beat) Today you were the person in the room who knew what to do. (beat) Today you got there.

22 EXT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - AMBULANCE BAY - NIGHT
SUNDAY, FEBRUARY 5, 2006 - 7:53 PM

The police tape is coming down. The crowd surges toward the hospital. Harmony comes out through the ER doors into the ambulance bay in her bloody T-shirt, hair wild, sneakers flapping without laces. Camille sees her from the street and runs. Harmony runs too. They collide under the overhang, in front of everybody, and Camille kisses her: hard, long, in the floodlights, in front of police officers, news cameras, nurses and God.

CAMILLE
(holding Harmony's face, crying)
Your text came at five fifty-one. (beat) "Pray for me, Choir." (beat) I've been praying for two hours on a curb.

HARMONY
(beat, laughing, sobbing)
I delivered a baby. (beat) In a stairwell. (beat) With my shoelaces.

Behind them, Lillian and Howard push through the crowd. Howard sees his daughter's bloody shirt and goes gray.

HOWARD
(beat)
Baby Girl. (beat) Whose blood is that?

HARMONY
(beat, beaming)
Elxa's, Daddy. (beat) And a little bit of Tuck's.

LILLIAN
(beat)
Who's Tuck?

HARMONY
(beat)
Elxa's son. (beat) Seven pounds, eleven ounces. (beat) Six forty-four p.m. (beat) Stairwell C. (beat) His middle name is Harmon.

Howard stares at his daughter. Then he starts to laugh, a big laugh that turns into a cough and back into a laugh, and he wraps his arms around his daughter and her girlfriend at the same time.

HOWARD
(into Harmony's hair)
They named him after you. (beat) Lord, Lil. (beat) They named a baby after our baby.

23 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - MAIN LOBBY - NIGHT
SUNDAY, FEBRUARY 5, 2006 - 8:01 PM

The lobby fills with people coming back in. Victor Donohue walks through the revolving door in his overcoat and fedora, Cedric at his elbow. He sees Marc across the lobby, bandaged, standing with Amond. Victor stops. Marc sees him. Victor walks to his grandson slowly, like a much older man, and puts his arms around him. For a long moment, he says nothing at all.

VICTOR
(finally, barely)
In 1957, my father gave me this. (beat) The day I graduated from Howard Medical.

He takes the gold pocket watch out of his vest pocket and unhooks the chain. He presses it into Marc's hand.

VICTOR
(beat)
He said, "Time is the only thing a Black doctor can't be cheated out of, Victor, if he spends it right." (beat) I've carried it every day for forty-nine years.

MARC
(staring at it)
Grandpa. (beat) I can't.

VICTOR
(beat, closing Marc's fingers around it)
You held a bomb for four hours today so a man could see his son grow up. (beat) You spent your time right. (beat) It's yours.

Marc looks down at the watch. It's ticking. He opens it. Engraved inside the lid, in old script: "V.D. -- 1957 -- SPEND IT RIGHT."

24 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - LABOR AND DELIVERY - ROOM 4 - NIGHT
SUNDAY, FEBRUARY 5, 2006 - 8:12 PM

Elxa, back in a real bed now, cleaned up and exhausted, holds Tuck. He's in a hospital blanket and a striped knit cap, but Harmony's white coat is folded on the chair beside the bed. Natasha sits on the bed. Robert comes in. He stops at the door.

ELXA
(softly)
Daddy. (beat) Come here.

Robert walks to the bed. Elxa lifts the baby toward him. Robert, who has held a thousand hearts in his hands, holds his first grandchild and doesn't know what to do with his face.

ROBERT
(barely)
Hello, young man. (beat) Hello.
(beat) I'm your granddaddy.

Tuck yawns enormously. Robert laughs and cries at the same time.

ROBERT
(beat, to Natasha)
He has my mother's chin.

NATASHA
(beat, smiling)
He has your mother's lungs.
(beat) Harmony said he screamed loud enough to be heard four floors up.

ELXA
(beat)
Dr. Hampton weighed him on the stairwell scale. (beat) The one in the NICU transport bag. (beat) Seven pounds, eleven ounces.
(beat) Twenty and a half inches.
(beat) Apgars eight and nine.
(beat) Harmony did that.

ROBERT
(beat, gently rocking him)
Then Harmony Divine can have anything she wants from this family for the rest of her life.

25 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - LABOR AND DELIVERY - CORRIDOR - NIGHT
SUNDAY, FEBRUARY 5, 2006 - 8:19 PM

Natasha steps out into the hallway to catch her breath. Down the corridor, a man in a camel overcoat stands by the nurses' station, holding a bouquet of grocery-store flowers awkwardly: Whitlow (56). He sees her and comes forward.

WHITLOW
(stiffly)
Natasha.

NATASHA
(beat, wary)
Horace.

WHITLOW
(beat)
I was at home. (beat) I saw it on Channel Two. (beat) I drove in. (beat) The police wouldn't let me past the barricade until twenty minutes ago.

He holds out the flowers. Natasha looks at them.

WHITLOW
(beat)
For your daughter. (beat) And the child. (beat) I'm told it's a boy.

NATASHA
(beat, taking them)
It's a boy.

WHITLOW
(beat, not quite meeting her eyes)
And I'm glad your son is alive, Natasha. (beat) Whatever else is true between us. (beat) I wanted you to hear me say it.

A long beat. Natasha studies her old enemy in the hallway light.

NATASHA
(beat, quietly)
Thank you, Horace.

Whitlow nods once and walks away down the corridor. Natasha stands holding the grocery-store flowers.

26 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - CVICU - BED 5 - NIGHT
SUNDAY, FEBRUARY 5, 2006 - 8:24 PM

The TV shows the start of the second half. Dash sits up in bed with a forbidden bag of Lay's in his lap. Glenda in the chair. Raven comes in, still in her scrubs, her eyes red, and sits down on the edge of the bed beside him.

DASH
(beat)
He walked out?

RAVEN
(beat)
He walked out. (beat) Cut on his eyebrow. (beat) Can't hear. (beat) His grandfather gave him a gold watch in the lobby.

DASH
(beat, softly)
Then it's the third quarter. (beat) You promised.

On the TV, the Steelers line up. The snap. Running back Willie Parker takes the handoff, cuts right and breaks into the open field, running untouched seventy-five yards for a touchdown. The crowd at Ford Field explodes. In the CVICU, Glenda cheers out loud. Dash laughs.

DASH
(beat, delighted)
Seventy-five yards! (beat) Longest run in Super Bowl history! (beat) Look at him go!

Raven starts to laugh too. Then she starts to cry. Dash takes her hand without looking away from the TV.

DASH
(beat, quietly)
It's okay. (beat) You can do both.

Glenda reaches over and takes Raven's other hand. The three of them sit in a chain again, the way they did at

noon, watching a man run seventy-five yards on a TV in a hospital where a man died two hours ago.

27 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - NEURO ICU - BED 2 - NIGHT
SUNDAY, FEBRUARY 5, 2006 - 8:41 PM

Russell, bandaged, intubated, the ICP monitor steady. Graves stands at the monitor. A nurse wheels Elxa in, in a wheelchair, holding Tuck. Esther pulls back the curtain for them. Elxa looks at her husband in the bed and makes a sound like something tearing.

GRAVES
(gently)
We've lightened his sedation, Dr. Bullock. (beat) He's been following commands for an hour. (beat) Talk to him.

Elxa leans forward in the wheelchair with the baby in her arms.

ELXA
(beat, barely)
Russell. (beat) Baby. (beat) It's me. (beat) Open your eyes.

A long beat. Russell's eyelids flutter. They open. Slowly, his eyes find his wife's face. Then they move down to the bundle in her arms. His eyes fill. Tears run down into the bandages.

ELXA
(crying)
This is Tuck. (beat) Russell Harmon Jeffries Junior. (beat) Six forty-four. (beat) In a stairwell. (beat) I waited as long as I could. (beat) I wouldn't push until they told me you were alive.

Russell lifts his right hand off the sheet. Elxa takes it and lays it on the baby's chest. Tuck's tiny fist closes around his father's finger.

ELXA
(beat, laughing through tears)
And the Steelers are winning. (beat) Fourteen to three. (beat) A seventy-five-yard run.

Behind the tube, Russell's face does something like a smile. He lifts his thumb. Graves, at the monitor, turns away and becomes very interested in the ICP number.

28 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - INTERNS' LOCKER ROOM - SHOWERS - NIGHT
SUNDAY, FEBRUARY 5, 2006 - 8:58 PM

The shower room, steamy and dim. One shower running. Marc stands under it fully dressed in his bloody scrubs, both hands braced against the tile wall, the water pouring over his head and down his back, the dust and blood running pink down the drain. He isn't moving. Victor's gold watch sits on the bench outside the stall, ticking.

The door opens. Esther comes in. She sees him. She doesn't say anything. She walks into the shower in her own scrubs and sneakers, stands behind him under the water and puts her arms around him from behind. He lets out a breath that turns into a sob.

MARC
(barely, too loud, still half deaf)
I couldn't hear it. (beat) The explosion. (beat) It was too loud to hear. (beat) There was just white. (beat) And then my father's face.

ESTHER
(into his back, though he can't hear her)
I know. (beat) I know.

In the doorway behind them, unseen, Clayton stands with two cups of coffee in his hands. He watches his wife hold the other man under the water for a long moment. Then he

sets one of the cups down on the bench beside the gold watch and walks away without making a sound.

29 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - INTERNS' LOCKER ROOM - NIGHT
SUNDAY, FEBRUARY 5, 2006 - 9:09 PM

Marc sits on the bench in dry scrubs, a towel around his neck, his hair dripping. Esther has gone. Natasha comes in and sits down on the bench beside her son.

NATASHA
(beat)
How are your ears?

MARC
(beat)
Better. (beat) Everybody sounds like they're in the next room.

NATASHA
(beat)
Good. (beat) Then you'll hear this. (beat) You were born on the steps of Widener Library.

Marc turns to look at her.

MARC
(beat)
What?

NATASHA
(beat)
January fifth, 1979. (beat) Four degrees. (beat) I had an exam in organic chemistry at nine. (beat) My water broke on the steps at eight-forty. (beat) A security guard named Alphonse caught you in his uniform jacket. (beat) I was so proud and so stubborn I'd told no one I was in labor.

MARC
(beat)
You never told me that.

NATASHA
(beat)
I told Elxa a month ago. (beat) I told your father this afternoon through a window. (beat) You're the last to know. (beat) You're always the last to know things in this family. (beat) I'm sorry about that, baby. (beat) Truly.

MARC
(beat)
Why are you telling me now?

NATASHA
(beat, taking his hand)
Because you came into this world in a hurry, on cold stone, with a stranger's hands under you. (beat) And today you knelt for four hours without moving while a stranger died for you. (beat) And I need you to know that I've been watching you be brave since before you could breathe. (beat) I'm not surprised by you, Marc-Anthony. (beat) I'm just so tired of being afraid for you.

Marc lays his head on his mother's shoulder, the way he did when he was six on the hospital roof.

MARC
(beat, barely)
Did you ever find Alphonse?

NATASHA
(beat)
Every Christmas until he died in 1994. (beat) A card and a hundred dollars. (beat) He called you "my boy."

30 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - INTERFAITH CHAPEL - NIGHT

SUNDAY, FEBRUARY 5, 2006 - 9:21 PM

The small chapel, lit by candles. Captain Ashford stands at the front with his hat in his hands. In the front pew sits a woman in her early forties in a church coat, very straight, very still: ANGELA BURRELL (42). Beside her, a girl of nearly eight in a puffy pink coat, holding her mother's arm: IMANI BURRELL (7). Natasha stands to one side. The door opens. Marc comes in, in fresh scrubs, his hair still wet, the bandage over his eye. He stops at the end of the aisle.

ASHFORD
(quietly)
Mrs. Burrell. (beat) This is the doctor.

Angela turns and looks at him. A long beat.

END OF ACT FOUR

ACT FIVE

31 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - INTERFAITH CHAPEL - NIGHT

SUNDAY, FEBRUARY 5, 2006 - 9:24 PM

Marc walks down the aisle and kneels in front of the pew so that he's at Imani's eye level. His hearing is better. Not good, but better.

MARC
(beat)
Mrs. Burrell. (beat) My name is Marc Bullock. (beat) I was with your husband today. (beat) For four hours. (beat) He talked to me the whole time so I wouldn't move.

ANGELA
(beat, barely)
What did he talk about?

MARC
(beat)
Kuwait. (beat) His hands. (beat) And Imani.

Imani looks up from her mother's arm.

MARC
(beat, to Imani)
Your birthday's on Tuesday. (beat) You're going to be eight.

IMANI
(beat, whispering)
Yeah.

MARC
(beat)
He told me you wanted a Sidekick phone. (beat) A pink one. (beat) He said your mom said no. (beat) He said he was going to say yes.

Imani looks at her mother. Angela's composure cracks. She puts a hand over her mouth.

MARC
(beat)
The last thing he said to me was, "Find yourself a Tuesday, son." (beat) He said Tuesday was his. (beat) Your birthday. (beat) That's what he was walking toward when he walked down that hall. (beat) Not away from anything. (beat) Toward Tuesday.

Angela reaches out and takes Marc's face in both hands, the way three people have tonight.

ANGELA
(beat, crying)
Thank you for telling me. (beat) Thank you for holding it, so he only had to carry it a little way.

32 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - SURGICAL ICU - BED 6 - NIGHT
SUNDAY, FEBRUARY 5, 2006 - 9:41 PM

Reggie Plummer, extubated now, groggy, an NG tube in his nose and a long dressing on his belly. LaShawn sits beside him with their toddler asleep on her shoulder in his Steelers knit cap. Lowery stands at the foot of the bed with the chart.

REGGIE
(hoarse, barely)
Did I... (beat) Did I miss the game?

LOWERY
(beat, dry)
Fourth quarter, Mr. Plummer. (beat) Pittsburgh's up by eleven.

Reggie closes his eyes and smiles weakly.

LASHAWN
(to Lowery)
They told me. (beat) What was in him. (beat) What it did in the hallway.

LOWERY
(beat)
Your husband has a hole in his side and two drains, Mrs. Plummer. (beat) He'll be here a week. (beat) He'll go home. (beat) He'll watch the next one on his own couch.

REGGIE
(eyes still closed)
Doc. (beat) The paramedic. (beat) The girl. (beat) The one with her hand in me. (beat) And the doctor who took it from her. (beat) And the cop. (beat) I want to know their names.

LOWERY
(beat, quietly)
Danita Crews. (beat) Marc Bullock. (beat) Sergeant Isaac Burrell. (beat) The sergeant died tonight, Mr. Plummer.

Reggie opens his eyes. He stares at the ceiling for a long time.

REGGIE
(barely)
Isaac Burrell. (beat) I'm going to name something after him. (beat) I don't know what yet. (beat) Something.

33 INT. MONTY'S ON JACKSON - BAR - NIGHT
SUNDAY, FEBRUARY 5, 2006 - 9:57 PM

The bar is packed again, but quiet. On the TV, the final whistle: STEELERS 21, SEAHAWKS 10. Confetti falls in

Detroit. Nobody cheers. Monty turns the sound off. He sets a row of shot glasses on the bar and fills them. Cedric, Kendra, Big Ray, Gloria, Mabry, the old regular and a dozen nurses and residents stand along the bar.

MONTY
(beat, raising a glass)
Sergeant Isaac Burrell. (beat) NYPD Bomb Squad. (beat) Marine. (beat) Daddy. (beat) He walked something out of a hospital so the rest of us didn't have to.

BIG RAY
(beat, raising his)
He stood at my desk at ten-forty this morning and asked me who was in charge. (beat) I said, "Of the hospital or the bomb?" (beat) He smiled. (beat) He was in charge of both.

GLORIA
(beat)
To Sergeant Burrell.

ALL
To Sergeant Burrell.

They drink. On the silent TV, a Steelers player holds up the Lombardi Trophy.

34 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - EMERGENCY DEPARTMENT - STAIRWELL D - NIGHT
SUNDAY, FEBRUARY 5, 2006 - 10:03 PM

Danita still sits on the landing, Kennerly beside her. Footsteps on the stairs. Marc comes down and stops. Danita looks up and sees the bandage, the wet hair. She scrambles to her feet.

DANITA
(beat, barely)
I left you. (beat) I ran. (beat) I left you with it, and I ran, and he's dead.

MARC
(beat, steady)
You didn't leave me, Danita. (beat) You handed him off. (beat) You held it in an ambulance, in an elevator, in an operating room. (beat) For four and a half hours. (beat) With a four-year-old at home. (beat) Then you handed it to me. (beat) And I handed it to him. (beat) And he carried it. (beat) That's not leaving. (beat) That's a relay.

DANITA
(beat, crying)
If I'd held on longer...

MARC
(beat)
Then your hand would have given out at three o'clock instead of two, and nothing would be different, except you'd be the one who couldn't hear tonight. (beat) It wasn't the hands, Danita. (beat) It was the pot. (beat) It was a sixty-year-old fuze. (beat) It was nobody's fault in this stairwell.

Danita steps forward and hugs him, fiercely. Kennerly, on the step, looks away to give them privacy.

35 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - CVICU - BED 5 - NIGHT
SUNDAY, FEBRUARY 5, 2006 - 10:09 PM

The game is over. Glenda has gone to the hotel. The TV is off. Raven sits on the edge of Dash's bed. He's quiet. The

empty Lay's bag is folded neatly on the tray table.

DASH
(beat)
Raven. (beat) Can I say something, and you don't say anything back until I'm done?

RAVEN
(beat)
Okay.

DASH
(beat)
A man walked down a hallway today carrying something that killed him. (beat) Everybody's going to spend tomorrow saying "if only." (beat) If only the pot held. If only the truck wasn't stuck on the Triborough. (beat) If only somebody had done something different.

Raven waits.

DASH
(beat)
If I go before a heart comes, (beat) and I might, (beat) don't you let anybody stand in this room and say "if only." (beat) Not Bullock. Not my mama. (beat) Not you. (beat) You hear me? (beat) You did everything. (beat) You washed my hair. (beat) You brought me decaf. (beat) You kept a promise in the third quarter. (beat) There's no "if only" in that.

RAVEN
(beat, barely)
Are you done?

DASH
(beat)
I'm done.

RAVEN
(beat, fierce, through tears)
Then here's mine. (beat) You're not going before a heart comes. (beat) And I don't want to hear you say that again. (beat) Not tonight. (beat) Not in this building. (beat) Not on the day a baby was born in a stairwell.

Dash looks at her for a long moment. Then he smiles, the gap-toothed grin.

DASH
(beat)
Yes, Doctor.

36 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - CVICU - NURSES' STATION - NIGHT
SUNDAY, FEBRUARY 5, 2006 - 10:17 PM

Robert writes post-op orders for the CABG patient. Amond stands beside him, filling in flowsheets. The unit is quiet.

ROBERT
(beat, not looking up)
You told me in OR Two. (beat) About Marc. (beat) After the patient was off pump.

AMOND
(beat)
Yes, sir.

ROBERT
(beat)
Not before.

AMOND
(beat)
If I'd told you before, your hands would have stopped. (beat) And he'd have died on the table. (beat) And Marc would never have forgiven either of us.

Robert puts down his pen. He looks at his protégé for a long time.

ROBERT
(beat)
That's the hardest kind of judgment there is, Dr. Baker. (beat) When to tell a man the truth. (beat) Most surgeons never learn it.

AMOND
(beat)
I learned it today.

ROBERT
(beat, quietly)
So did I. (beat) This week, I'm going to tell my wife something I should have told her twenty-four years ago. (beat) I'd like to have learned it from you sooner.

Amond looks at him. He knows exactly what Robert means; he heard Langley in Bed 3. He says nothing about it.

AMOND
(beat)
Then tell her, sir. (beat) Not because it'll be easy. (beat) Because she deserves to know where her blood is going.

37 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - PARKING GARAGE - LEVEL 2 - NIGHT
SUNDAY, FEBRUARY 5, 2006 - 10:26 PM

Robert and Natasha stand beside the silver Mercedes. Neither of them has gotten in. Natasha still holds Whitlow's grocery-store flowers.

ROBERT
(beat)
Tasha. (beat) Today, through that window, I made a promise. (beat) If he walked out of that room, I'd stop carrying things I should have set down a long time ago.

Natasha looks at him.

ROBERT
(beat)
There's something I need to tell you. (beat) About Chicago. (beat) About 1981. (beat) Not tonight. (beat) Tonight belongs to Tuck. (beat) But this week. (beat) Before I lose my nerve.

NATASHA
(beat, very quietly)
I know there's something, Robert.

ROBERT
(beat)
How long have you known?

NATASHA
(beat)
Since the Chicago postmark. (beat) Maybe since 1982. (beat) I don't know. (beat) A woman knows when her husband comes home from a conference and holds her too tight.

Robert closes his eyes.

NATASHA
(beat, taking his hand)
This week. (beat) Tonight, we go upstairs and hold our grandson.

38 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - LABOR AND DELIVERY - FAMILY LOUNGE - NIGHT
SUNDAY, FEBRUARY 5, 2006 - 10:37 PM

A small lounge with a vending machine and a window looking down on Jackson Avenue, where the TV vans are packing up. Victor sits on a vinyl sofa with his overcoat folded on his knees, his vest pocket conspicuously empty. Natasha comes in and sits beside her father.

NATASHA
(beat)
You gave him Granddaddy's watch.

VICTOR
(beat)
I gave him my father's watch.

NATASHA
(beat)
V.J. asked you for that watch at his medical school graduation, Daddy. (beat) In 1985. (beat) You said, "When you've earned it."

VICTOR
(beat, looking out the window)
V.J. is a fine doctor. (beat) He's never held a bomb.

A long beat.

VICTOR
(beat, quietly)
Natasha. (beat) We said spring. (beat) For the boy. (beat) For everything in that letter. (beat) I stood at a police barricade today, and I thought, I am seventy-two years old, and I almost didn't get to tell him myself. (beat) I don't want to wait for spring.

NATASHA
(beat, very carefully)
He's twenty-seven, Daddy. (beat) He's an intern. (beat) He just watched a man die.

VICTOR
(beat)
Then not this week. (beat) But soon. (beat) Before something else happens that I can't control.

Natasha takes her father's hand. They sit together and watch the last TV van drive away down Jackson Avenue.

39 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - SURGEONS' LOUNGE - CORRIDOR - NIGHT
SUNDAY, FEBRUARY 5, 2006 - 10:44 PM

Marc walks down a quiet corridor with his phone pressed to his good ear, a finger in the other. Victor's watch is in his scrub pocket.

GRACE (V.O.)
(on the phone, from Boston, breathless, crying)
...it was on CNN! (beat) CNN, Marc! (beat) "Doctor holds live shell." (beat) They didn't say your name, and I knew. (beat) I knew it was you. (beat) I called Mama nine times. (beat) I called Elxa. (beat) Nobody picked up. (beat) Grandpa's phone went straight to voicemail.

MARC
(beat)
Grandpa was at the barricade, Gracie. (beat) He walked right past a cop.

GRACE (V.O.)
(beat)
Of course he did. (beat) Are you hurt? (beat) Tell me exactly. (beat) Don't make it small.

MARC
(beat)
A cut over my left eye. (beat) Four Steri-Strips. (beat) My ears are ringing. (beat) Temporary threshold shift. (beat) Gloria says a day or two.

GRACE (V.O.)
(beat)
Blast-induced threshold shift resolves in about seventy percent of cases within forty-eight hours. (beat) I'm reading it right now. (beat) In the Harvard library. (beat) At ten forty-five at night. (beat) Because I didn't know what else to do.

MARC
(beat, almost smiling)
Gracepedia.

GRACE (V.O.)
(beat, crying)
And Elxa had the baby in a stairwell? (beat) During the bomb? (beat) Is that real? (beat) Is our family insane?

MARC
(beat)
Seven pounds, eleven ounces. (beat) His name's Tuck. (beat) You're an aunt, Gracie.

A long silence on the line. Then a sound from Boston: Grace Bullock, twenty-four, crying and laughing in a library at the same time.

40 INT. THE HOUSE ON 49TH AVENUE - KITCHEN - NIGHT
SUNDAY, FEBRUARY 5, 2006 - 10:52 PM

The dark, empty house. Nobody has been home all day. A key turns in the front door. Big Ray Toles lets himself in with a spare key from the security office and switches on the kitchen light. Mercy, frantic, desperate, comes skidding across the kitchen floor, whimpering, and throws herself at his legs.

BIG RAY
(crouching, gruff)
I know, baby. (beat) I know. (beat) Nobody's been home since six this morning. (beat) Your daddy had a long day.

He fills her water bowl. He finds the bag of kibble and fills her food bowl with the "MERCY" stenciled on it. He clips on her leash, the red collar jingling.

BIG RAY
(beat)
Come on. (beat) Let's go for a walk. (beat) Then I'll take you to see him.

41 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - AMBULANCE BAY - NIGHT
SUNDAY, FEBRUARY 5, 2006 - 10:58 PM

The ambulance bay, quiet now. Camille stands under the overhang in her Saints jacket, her phone at her ear, her other hand over her mouth.

CAMILLE
(into the phone, barely)
Papa.

AUGUSTIN (V.O.)
(on the phone, his voice rough)
I saw it on the television. (beat) Your hospital. (beat) A bomb. (beat) I called you eleven times. (beat) You didn't answer.

CAMILLE
(beat)
They turned off the phones, Papa. (beat) For the bomb. (beat) I'm okay. (beat) I was outside the whole time. (beat) I'm okay.

AUGUSTIN (V.O.)
(beat)
Eleven times, Camille. (beat) I sat on the couch in Halsey Street with the rosary I gave you in my head because it is in your pocket. (beat) I have lost a city. (beat) I have lost a hotel. (beat) Tonight I thought I had lost my daughter.

Camille starts to cry.

AUGUSTIN (V.O.)
(beat, a long pause, then very carefully)
And the girl. (beat) Harmony. (beat) Is she safe?

Camille stops breathing.

CAMILLE
(beat, barely)
She delivered a baby, Papa. (beat) In a stairwell. (beat) During the bomb. (beat) With her shoelaces.

AUGUSTIN (V.O.)
(beat, a sound almost like a laugh)
Shoelaces. (beat) Mon Dieu. (beat) Your mother delivered your cousin Lucien in the kitchen on Elysian Fields in 1979 with a pair of poultry shears. (beat) I never forgave her for the shears. (beat) They were good shears.

CAMILLE
(laughing and crying)
Papa.

AUGUSTIN (V.O.)
(beat, quietly)
Tell her I asked, Camille. (beat) That's all. (beat) Tell her an old man from New Orleans asked if she was safe.

42 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - LABOR AND DELIVERY - ROOM 4 - NIGHT
SUNDAY, FEBRUARY 5, 2006 - 11:02 PM

Elxa is awake again, propped on pillows, Tuck asleep on her chest. The room is empty except for Harmony, who has

come back to return Elxa's phone and stands awkwardly at the foot of the bed.

ELXA
(beat)
Divine. (beat) Sit.

Harmony sits on the edge of the chair.

ELXA
(beat)
In July, you threw up in a trash can on your first day. (beat) Outside OR Three. (beat) I saw you. (beat) I told you to wipe your mouth and get back in there.

HARMONY
(beat)
I remember.

ELXA
(beat)
That same week you froze in your first appendectomy, and Cummings called you "Double-O." (beat) "Licensed to kill." (beat) And I used it. (beat) In front of the whole floor. (beat) For months. (beat) To make you feel small.

HARMONY
(beat, quietly)
I know.

ELXA
(beat, looking down at her son)
Today you knelt on concrete for an hour and caught my son with your bare hands. (beat) During a bomb. (beat) You didn't freeze. (beat) You didn't throw up. (beat) You tied his cord with your own shoelaces. (beat) And I'm never calling you Double-O again unless you want me to.

HARMONY
(beat, a wet laugh)
I kind of like it now.

ELXA
(beat)
Then it means something different now. (beat) It means the one who's licensed to save lives. (beat) Thank you, Harmony.

It's the first time Elxa Bullock has ever called her by her first name.

43 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - SURGEONS' LOUNGE - NIGHT
SUNDAY, FEBRUARY 5, 2006 - 11:06 PM

A small lounge, empty. Lowery sits alone on the sofa in his scrubs with his white hair standing up, staring at nothing. His hands are still in his lap now. The door opens. Gloria comes in with two cups of tea. She sits down beside him and hands him one.

GLORIA
(beat)
Abraham.

LOWERY
(beat, not looking at her)
Thirty-one years, Gloria. (beat) I've never been afraid in an operating room. (beat) Not once. (beat) Today I was afraid for eight hours. (beat) And the one man in that room who wasn't afraid is dead.

GLORIA
(beat)
He was afraid. (beat) He was just better at carrying it.

Lowery holds the tea. His shoulders begin to shake. Gloria Pettiford, who has known him since 1975, puts her arm around him, and the old surgeon who has made four chiefs of surgery cry finally cries himself.

44 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - LABOR AND DELIVERY - ROOM 4 - NIGHT
SUNDAY, FEBRUARY 5, 2006 - 11:18 PM

Elxa asleep at last. Tuck in a bassinet beside the bed. Harmony, in a fresh scrub top, sits in the chair holding him, Camille beside her. Lillian and Howard stand over them. Howard holds out one big finger, and Tuck grabs it.

HOWARD
(beat, whispering)
Hey, little man. (beat) Russell Harmon. (beat) That's a good name. (beat) That's a strong name.

LILLIAN
(beat, to Harmony, softly)
When you were born, Baby Girl, the doctor almost dropped you. (beat) You came so fast. (beat) Your daddy caught you with one hand. (beat) Like a fly ball.

HARMONY
(beat, laughing quietly)
Daddy caught me?

HOWARD
(beat, proudly)
Left hand. (beat) Thirty-one years on the Q4, I've never dropped anything.

Harmony looks down at the baby in her arms. Then at her father.

HARMONY
(beat, barely)
I guess it runs in the family.

45 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - ON-CALL ROOM 2 - NIGHT
SUNDAY, FEBRUARY 5, 2006 - 11:33 PM

Raven sits on the bottom bunk. Arianna sits on the other end. They're both too exhausted to change. A long silence.

ARIANNA
(beat)
When the building shook, (beat) the first thing I thought about was you. (beat) Where you were. (beat) If you were okay. (beat) Before Marc. (beat) Before anybody.

RAVEN
(beat, honestly)
When the building shook, I thought about Marc first. (beat) Then you. (beat) Then him. (beat) Dash. (beat) All three, in about half a second. (beat) I'm not going to lie to you anymore. (beat) That's the truth.

Arianna looks at her.

ARIANNA
(beat)
That's the truth.

RAVEN
(beat)
That's the truth.

ARIANNA
(beat, nodding slowly)
Okay. (beat) Then I can work with it.

She doesn't move closer. But she lies down on the bunk with her feet next to Raven's, and Raven lies down with her head at the other end, and within a minute both of them are asleep.

46 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - CAFETERIA - NIGHT
SUNDAY, FEBRUARY 5, 2006 - 11:42 PM

The cafeteria, closed, the chairs up on most of the tables. One table is still down. Clayton sits at it with a cold cup of coffee. Esther comes in, her scrubs still damp, and sits across from him.

ESTHER
(beat)
You were in the locker room. (beat) In the doorway. (beat) You left a coffee on the bench.

CLAYTON
(beat)
I did.

ESTHER
(beat)
I was going to tell you. (beat) No more Octobers. (beat) I was coming to tell you right now.

CLAYTON
(beat, quietly)
I know you were.

A long beat.

CLAYTON
(beat)
Esther. (beat) Today a man held a bomb for four hours, and another man died carrying it, and a baby was born in a stairwell. (beat) And the man you love walked out of that room alive. (beat) You held him in a shower. (beat) I'm not going to make that into an October. (beat) It isn't one. (beat) It's just Sunday.

ESTHER
(beat, barely)
Clayton.

CLAYTON
(beat, standing, picking up his coffee)
I'm going to drive us home to Remsen Street. (beat) And tomorrow, or the next day, we'll go to Montague Street and Dr. Greenidge can have a field day. (beat) But tonight, I'm just glad he's alive. (beat) That's the truth. (beat) I'm glad he's alive.

TAG

47 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - NICU NURSERY WINDOW - NIGHT
SUNDAY, FEBRUARY 5, 2006 - 11:51 PM

Through the nursery window, a row of bassinets. One card reads, in a nurse's careful marker: "JEFFRIES, RUSSELL HARMON JR. ('TUCK'). 7 LB 11 OZ. 20.5 IN. 6:44 PM. STAIRWELL C. DELIVERED BY: DR. H. DIVINE." Someone has drawn a small football on the card.

MARC (V.O.)
They teach you in medical school that the body has its own wisdom.

48 EXT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - ROOF - NIGHT
SUNDAY, FEBRUARY 5, 2006 - 11:59 PM

The helipad. The rain has cleared, and the Manhattan skyline is sharp and bright. Marc sits on the edge of the pad with Mercy, whom Big Ray brought up the service stairs, pressed against his side. Victor's gold watch is open in his palm, ticking. He can hear it now, faintly, beneath the ringing.

MARC (V.O.)
That the body knows before the mind does.

The second hand sweeps toward twelve.

MARC (V.O.)
This morning, my body knew something bad was going to happen. (beat) It was right.

Midnight. Monday.

MARC (V.O.)
What it didn't know, what no body knows, is that the worst day of your life and the best one can be the same day. (beat) A man can die walking toward Tuesday. (beat) And a boy can be born in a stairwell. (beat) In the same building. (beat) Thirteen minutes apart.

He closes the watch. Mercy sighs and rests her head on his knee.

MARC (V.O.)
Spend it right.

FADE OUT.

END OF EPISODE

Media Companion: Episode 2x17

Off-screen media around the episode, in chronological order. Not counted in page length (MA-009 §5).

NEW YORK DAILY NEWS (front page): "HERO"

Monday, February 6, 2006

"Bomb Squad Sgt. Isaac Burrell, 44, a Marine veteran and 17-year NYPD officer, was killed Sunday evening when a World War II-era artillery shell he had just carried out of an operating room exploded in a service corridor at Queens Grace Hospital. Doctors had removed the shell from a construction worker, who survived... Commissioner Kelly called Burrell 'the bravest man in New York tonight.'" (A fictional event.)

ASSOCIATED PRESS: "STEELERS WIN FIFTH SUPER BOWL, 21-10"

Sunday, February 5, 2006

"DETROIT (AP) -- Willie Parker broke the longest run in Super Bowl history, a 75-yard touchdown on the second play of the second half, and Antwaan Randle El threw a 43-yard touchdown pass to MVP Hines Ward as Pittsburgh beat Seattle 21-10..."

QueensGraceConfidential (Blogger)

Monday, February 6, 2006, 12:41 AM

"WE LOST ONE OF THE GOOD ONES. Sergeant Isaac Burrell carried that thing out of OR 1 so nobody else had to. The staff lined the loading dock for him at 7:24 PM. If you were there, you know. If you weren't, ask somebody who was. And at 6:44 PM, thirteen minutes after the blast, a baby boy was born in Stairwell C, caught by an intern with her shoelaces. His middle name is HARMON. That's all we have tonight. Hold on to somebody." Comments (6,902).

Bassinet card, QGH Newborn Nursery

Sunday, February 5, 2006

"JEFFRIES, RUSSELL HARMON JR. ('TUCK'). 7 LB 11 OZ. 20.5 IN. 6:44 PM. STAIRWELL C. DELIVERED BY: DR. H. DIVINE." (A small football is drawn in the corner.)

Engraving inside Victor Donohue's pocket watch (now Marc's)

Given 1957; passed to Marc February 5, 2006

"V.D. -- 1957 -- SPEND IT RIGHT."

Last radio transmission, Sgt. Isaac Burrell (per Capt. Ashford)

Sunday, February 5, 2006, about 6:25 PM

"The doctor's clear. Starting my walk."

Continuity Sheet: Episode 2x17 (Part Two)

New Canon Established

- **THE SHELL:** at 6:22 PM Marc lifted the 37mm projectile out of Reggie Plummer and placed it in Burrell's hands. Burrell sealed it in the portable pot ('Find yourself a Tuesday, son') and walked it down the old-wing service corridor toward the loading dock. **At 6:31 PM the pot failed and the shell detonated about 20 feet from the dock. Det. Sgt. Isaac Burrell was killed.** His last radio report: 'The doctor's clear. Starting my walk.' Marc was thrown under the scrub sink. He has a cut over his left eyebrow (Steri-Strips by Gloria), **intact eardrums and a temporary threshold shift** (hearing returning; tinnitus may last a week). No permanent injury. Reggie survived (Lowery and Mabry closed) and was extubated by 9:41 PM. He wants to 'name something after' Burrell.
- **TUCK IS BORN** per MA-005: **Russell Harmon 'Tuck' Jeffries Jr., 6:44 PM, February 5, 2006, Stairwell C, delivered by Harmony Divine**, 13 minutes after the blast (which shook the stairwell mid-push). There was a nuchal cord, reduced over the head by Harmony with Dr. Hampton coaching by phone. The cord was tied with Harmony's shoelaces and cut with bandage scissors. He weighed 7 lb 11 oz, measured 20.5 in, and had Apgars of 8 and 9. **Nickname origin:** Harmony swaddled him in her white coat ('tucked in like a burrito'). **Middle name 'Harmon' after Harmony**, chosen by Elxa on the landing. Natasha first held him on the stairs at 7:33 PM, when the lockdown lifted, and wept for the first time that day. Robert: 'He has my mother's chin.' This was Dr. Hampton's first delivery by phone in 28 years.
- **Russell** woke in the Neuro ICU, saw his son and lifted a thumb when Elxa told him the Steelers were winning. His ICP spiked to 28 at the blast and Esther controlled it. He is still intubated, with the bone flap banked.
- **The honor line** at 7:24 PM: bomb squad, police, then hospital staff (Big Ray, Mabry, Lowery, Miss Hattie, nurses) lined the loading-dock path as Burrell's flag-draped body was carried out. Marc laid his right hand, the hand that held the shell, over his heart. **Capt. Neville Ashford** (56) commands the squad; Burrell served under him for 11 years. **Marc told Angela and Imani Burrell** in the chapel about the pink Sidekick and Tuesday: 'He was walking toward Tuesday.' Angela: 'Thank you for holding it, so he only had to carry it a little way.' Monty's toasted Burrell at the final whistle (Steelers 21-10).
- **VICTOR GAVE MARC HIS FATHER'S GOLD POCKET WATCH** in the lobby (engraved 'V.D. -- 1957 -- SPEND IT RIGHT'), the watch V.J. asked for in 1985 and was refused: 'When you've earned it.' **Victor wants to move up the heir revelation** ('We said spring... I don't want to wait'). Natasha: 'Not this week. But soon.' The heir designation is still secret from Marc's friends.
- **Robert promised Natasha he'll tell her 'about Chicago, about 1981' THIS WEEK.** Natasha: 'I know there's something... Since the Chicago postmark. Maybe since 1982... when her husband comes home from a conference and holds her too tight.' Per MA-005 the Mariah reveal (the daughter) stays in Season 11. What Robert confesses next is the affair only, and he still hasn't opened the letter. **Amond: 'You're not my day one, Marc. You're my brother.'**

- **Harmony and Camille kissed publicly in the ambulance bay.** Howard: 'They named a baby after our baby.' Howard caught newborn Harmony left-handed 'like a fly ball.' **Whitlow brought flowers** to Natasha: 'I'm glad your son is alive... Whatever else is true between us.' **Esther held Marc in the shower; Clayton saw and left a coffee.** Clayton: 'I'm not going to make that into an October... I'm glad he's alive.' **Raven to Arianna, in honest order:** 'Marc first. Then you. Then him.' Arianna: 'Then I can work with it.' Raven watched Willie Parker's 75-yard run with Dash and Glenda as promised. Kennerly sat with Danita, and Marc told her: 'That's a relay.' Lowery broke down with Gloria. Big Ray fed and walked Mercy and brought her to Marc on the roof. Grace called from the Harvard library: 'Is our family insane?'

Knowledge Tracker (as of 11:59 PM, February 5, 2006)

Item	Who knows
Tuck's name, middle name and nickname origin	Everyone (the bassinet card, the blog)
Robert will confess 'Chicago, 1981' this week	Robert, Natasha
Victor wants to reveal the heir designation sooner	Victor, Natasha
The watch (Victor's father's)	Marc, Victor, Natasha (and V.J.'s 1985 refusal)
Esther and Marc in the shower	Esther, Marc, Clayton

Patient Registry

Patient	DOB / age	Diagnosis	Procedure / surgeon	Outcome
Reggie Plummer	10/30/1967 (38)	Retained live 37mm projectile, left retroperitoneum	Shell removed by hand (Bullock), handed to EOD; closure (Lowery; Mabry)	Extubated; recovering
Tuck Jeffries	2/5/2006	Term newborn; nuchal cord x1	Stairwell delivery (Divine; Hampton by phone)	Apgars 8/9; healthy
Dr. Elxa Bullock	8/29/1977 (28)	SVD at 39w2d in a stairwell	(Divine; Hartwell and Hampton after 7:33 PM)	Well
Russell Jeffries	4/3/1975 (30)	Post-craniectomy for acute SDH; ICP spike at the blast	Propofol (Smilley; Graves)	ICP 12; following commands
Dr. Marc Bullock	1/5/1979 (27)	Blast exposure: left brow laceration, temporary threshold shift	Steri-Strips; otoscopy (Pettiford)	Hearing returning
Det. Sgt. Isaac Burrell	9/14/1961 (44)	Blast injury	-	Killed in the line of duty, 6:31 PM

New Characters

- **Captain Neville Ashford** (b. December 8, 1949), NYPD Bomb Squad. **Angela Burrell** (b. July 22, 1963) and **Imani Burrell** (b. February 7, 1998). **Russell Harmon 'Tuck' Jeffries Jr.** (b. February 5, 2006), per MA-005.

Real-World Accuracy Notes

- Super Bowl XL, February 5, 2006, Ford Field, Detroit: Pittsburgh 21, Seattle 10. Willie Parker's 75-yard run on the second play of the second half was the longest run in Super Bowl history at the time, and Hines Ward was MVP after a 43-yard touchdown pass from Antwaan Randle El. Ray Kelly was NYPD Commissioner in 2006. The Bomb Squad honor line, the shell and Sgt. Burrell are fictional.
- Medicine: blast overpressure can cause temporary threshold shift and tinnitus even with intact tympanic membranes, usually resolving within days. A nuchal cord found at delivery is reduced over the head if loose. With no clamp available, clean ties (e.g., shoelaces) are an accepted field improvisation for cord ligation. Elevated ICP after craniectomy is managed with sedation, osmotherapy and drainage. Newborn Apgars are scored at 1 and 5 minutes.